

A

Location*

“We live **on the outskirts of town**¹, and it’s a very nice **location**. We used to live in the centre, but we **moved**² to our present flat when we had children because there’s more **space**³ for them to play and it has nice **views**⁴.”

* the place and position of something

¹ on the edge of town

² changed the place where we live

³ an area that is empty or not used

⁴ the things you can see from a place

B

Our flat

“This is where we live. We **rent**¹ a flat **on the second floor**. There’s a family in the flat **downstairs**², and a young French couple **upstairs**, on the top floor. It’s a modern **block of flats**³, and it’s quite good, although the **lift**⁴ is small, and there’s no **air conditioning**⁵.”

¹ pay money every week/month to use it because it isn’t ours

² on a lower level of a building

³ a building with a number of flats in it

⁴ the machine that takes people up or down a floor

⁵ a system that keeps the air cool

Language help

Flat is more common in British English; **apartment** is used in American English but is becoming more common in British English. Apartments are usually in large buildings; flats can be in a large building or part of a larger house.



C

A house in the country

“My parents **own**¹ a **cottage**². It’s a **charming**³ house and **has lots of character**⁴, but like many old buildings, it’s quite **dark** (*opp light*), quite difficult to **heat**⁵, and it doesn’t have **central heating**⁶.”

¹ they bought it

² a small house, that is old and attractive, and usually found in the country

³ pleasant and attractive

⁴ it is interesting and unusual

⁵ make warm or hot

⁶ a system that heats a whole house



cottage